

THE HOLOCAUST

Between 1941 and 1945, the Nazis and their collaborators murdered more than six million European Jews. This genocide (a mass killing intended to wipe out an entire group of people) was known as the Holocaust. Millions of others—Poles, Roma, Russians, political protesters, and homosexual people—were killed alongside them.

Adolf Hitler and the Nazis were antisemitic (hated Jewish people) and believed Jews were responsible for Germany's problems. When the Nazis came to power in 1933, they passed laws to strip Jews of their rights as citizens. After World War II began in 1939, the Nazis forced Jews, primarily from occupied Poland and areas of the USSR,



◀ THE YELLOW BADGE

After September 1, 1941, all Jews in Nazi-occupied lands were forced to wear a star with the word Jude (Jew) written on it. These identification badges were meant to be a mark of shame.

inside ghettos—sectioned off city areas. Here, Jews lived in cramped conditions with very little food, and many were murdered by death squads. Jews were also sent to labor camps where they were worked to death, and from 1941 to death camps, where millions of Jews were killed.

Yet many Jews fought against the tyranny of the Nazis. Secret resistance groups performed acts of sabotage, or organized armed uprisings from within the ghettos and camps.

CHILD IN TIME

Anne Frank (1929–1945) was born to a Jewish family in Germany. The Franks moved to Amsterdam when the Nazis came to power, and when Germany occupied the Netherlands they went into hiding. They lived in a small space, constantly in fear of discovery, for two years. During this time Anne wrote about her daily life in a diary. After her capture and death, the diary was found and published. It has been translated into more than 70 languages.



WARSAW GHETTO

The Nazis set up more than 1,000 ghettos to confine and control the Jews. The Warsaw Ghetto in Poland was the largest, with up to 460,000 Jews imprisoned there. From the ghetto, many were sent to their deaths at Treblinka camp.